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CFO-ORC FILE .. 2000 - 5

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

Red 12/8/00

Species: Red-necked Grebe (*Podiceps grisegena*)**Date:** 3 November 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** ?**Plumage:** Basic I**Locality:** Pueblo Reservoir**Elevation:** about 5000'**Nearest town:** Pueblo West**County:** Pueblo**Time observed:** 10:55 - 11:10 MDT**Duration of observation:** off and on for about 5 minutes during that time

Description: Doug Faulkner and I went to Pueblo Reservoir to look for various interesting birds that had been present recently. We met Brandon Percival at the north side at the Juniper Breaks campground to look for the Red-necked Grebe and the Red-throated Loon that Brandon had seen earlier that day. After Doug refound the loon and we watched it, I refound the grebe. We watched the grebe for a while and saw it dive from the surface once or twice.

It was a fairly large grebe, considerably smaller than the Western Grebes on the lake and larger than the Eared Grebes. It was overall fairly dark. The top half of the head was blackish with a post-auricular pale gray patch. The rest of the head was darker gray and the pointed bill, which was fairly thick and relatively long for a grebe, was yellowish. The back was blackish and the throat and neck were pale-medium gray.

Similar species eliminated: There isn't particularly a species similar to Red-necked Grebe. Various diving ducks (e.g., Red-breasted Merganser) are eliminated by the long, thin, dagger-like bill, the bill color, and the head pattern. All loons are easily eliminated by coloration and pattern.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No vocalizations heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 10s of 1000s of Red-necked Grebes and 1000s of all other Colorado grebe species. I've also seen 100s to 10s of 1000s of all ducks that could be even remotely confused with Red-necked Grebe.

Light conditions: sun in front and to my left

Optical equipment used: Leica 32x

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest approach of about 1200 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Doug Faulkner, Brandon Percival

Other observers who saw the bird independently: many, including Mark Janos

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none **b) after observation:** none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Tony Leukering", with a stylized flourish at the end.

Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 13 November & 7 December 2000 from brief notes I wrote some eight hours after the sighting